Interview document

Proposed role and follow-up interview discussion

Sarah Blanch · Prepared 11 October 2026

The role I want

I want responsibility for improving how the business works as a whole: its systems, automation, client journey and growth. I want to connect the work across the Bottrell businesses so improvements in one area make the others work better.

My strongest interest is reviewing, then building and improving systems, and using evidence to see whether they work. Marketing, IT, coding and development, finance administration and building operations all fit into that remit, with each contributing to how the business runs and grows. I am looking for a senior role with clear outcomes, room to use my judgement and direct access to the people making decisions.

Business Systems & Growth Lead is a proposed working title. We should agree the remit first, then choose the title that fits your structure.

I'm willing to build towards this level of responsibility, earning your trust through results and taking on greater authority over time. A 90-day review would let us assess my results and agree how my remit and decision-making authority should develop. My goal is a senior, challenging role where I can help grow and improve the business.

Why I can contribute

At Newcastle City Business Centre, I worked in a senior position and handled difficult client and building situations. These ranged from distressed inmate calls to upset medico-legal appointment attendees and meeting-room users, including people angry about workers' compensation or other outcomes. I dealt with tenant complaints about our service, including being yelled at after interrupting a client session because of noise, accessibility issues affecting client retention, and requests for rent reductions. I also tracked down people who had entered the building, gone to other floors and harassed private tenants, arranging for them to leave with minimal disruption or calling police when needed to keep staff and tenants safe.

Throughout these situations, I remained professional and represented the business well. With experience, I could recognise when an apology, discount, fee waiver or another remedy was appropriate, but each step still required owner approval. I would like to earn agreed authority to resolve issues within clear limits, with a consistent process for escalation and follow-up. Client management is ongoing: I want to use complaint patterns to anticipate and reduce dissatisfaction and rude or disruptive behaviour, especially as the business grows and new staff are onboarded.

When I decided to leave, I stayed on at an increased hourly rate with a retention bonus to train replacement staff and complete my projects, leaving on good terms.

I work well with clear priorities and immediate, honest feedback. I want to know when something needs changing, and I take responsibility for following through.

What I would own

- **Systems and workflows:** map the work from enquiry through handover, identify repeated work and unclear ownership, and coordinate agreed improvements.
- **Automation:** select useful tasks, build or coordinate small pilots, test them against the current process and document how staff use them; then extend to larger, more complex workflows as I build the system knowledge and experience to deliver them reliably.
- **Client experience:** improve enquiry routing, handovers and follow-up, with measurable tracking of response times, completed handovers and follow-up outcomes; help turn the business's client boundaries into clear staff procedures.
- **Growth and marketing:** keep business information consistent, improve the buyer's route to the right service and run measurable experiments that fit delivery capacity.
- **Onboarding systems:** review and improve the common induction, role-specific materials and readiness tracking with service leads and designated trainers.
- **Owner reporting:** make priorities, progress, unresolved decisions and meaningful measures easy to see.

The role would serve the agreed businesses while respecting each legal provider and the people responsible for professional advice. Finance administration can support this remit. Routine office administration and basic supervision of junior staff should remain a limited part of it, so improvement work has protected time.

First three months

Period	Deliverables
First 30 days	Understand the team and current systems; review onboarding and training ownership; agree responsibilities and priorities; establish an enquiry and workflow baseline; confirm the correct service routes and business information; fix approved quick wins.
Days 31–60	Improve one important workflow; deliver and evaluate one automation pilot; establish a business-information register and change process; give the owners a concise progress report.
Days 61–90	Review the evidence from the pilot and client journey; recommend what to expand, change or stop; run one approved marketing experiment; hold a 90-day review of results, responsibilities and decision-making authority; agree the next quarter's priorities.

We would agree targets after measuring the starting point. Useful measures include enquiry response time, completed handovers, rework and demonstrated time saved. Growth measures need actual enquiries, engagements and delivery capacity.

How the role would work

I would like one clear reporting line, direct feedback and agreed authority for routine decisions. Larger spending, changes to professional disclosures, regulated advice and major system changes would stay with the appropriate decision-makers. I can coordinate with a capable team and help train people when needed; continual basic staff supervision should not define the role.

I prefer a hybrid arrangement with the average number of home-working days written into the contract. Two days a week is my preferred arrangement. I can work around onboarding and the business's needs, with the detailed pattern agreed together. Protected focus time lets me complete deeper systems work.

The base salary should reflect the agreed responsibility before any bonus. Hours, reporting line, scope and decision authority need to be settled alongside pay.

Questions for Rebecca

The 20 questions can be answered in the online form (https://sarahblanch.com/bottrell/questions.html) or the printable workbook (https://sarahblanch.com/bottrell/pdf/questions-for-rebecca.pdf). Both use the same questions; the workbook provides space for handwritten answers.